



Why this story

SCMP (Nov 2025): HK falls short in empowering women at work

TWF on Equal Pay Day: Female managers earn significantly less than male

KPMG & TWF 2024: Women hold 45% of senior roles, 37% of board seats

Question: If more women reach the top, why do they still earn less?

Is the glass ceiling gone — or just harder to see?

Hong Kong society Opinion / Hong Kong Opinion



Opinion | Alice Wu

Hong Kong must do more to empower women in the workforce

3 Datasets

Dataset 1: Employed persons by monthly earnings, age & sex — 1986 to 2024 (HK CSD)

Dataset 2: Median monthly earnings by occupation & sex — 2016 to 2025 (HK CSD)

Dataset 3: Number of managers by sex — 2016 to 2025 (HK CSD)

Process

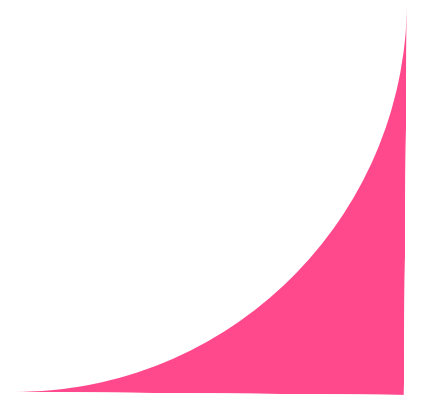
Process: Started with 5 datasets → refined to 3 after instructor feedback (removed weak/HK-absent data)

Story built on 3-layer argument

structural gap → representation rising → but pay gap persists

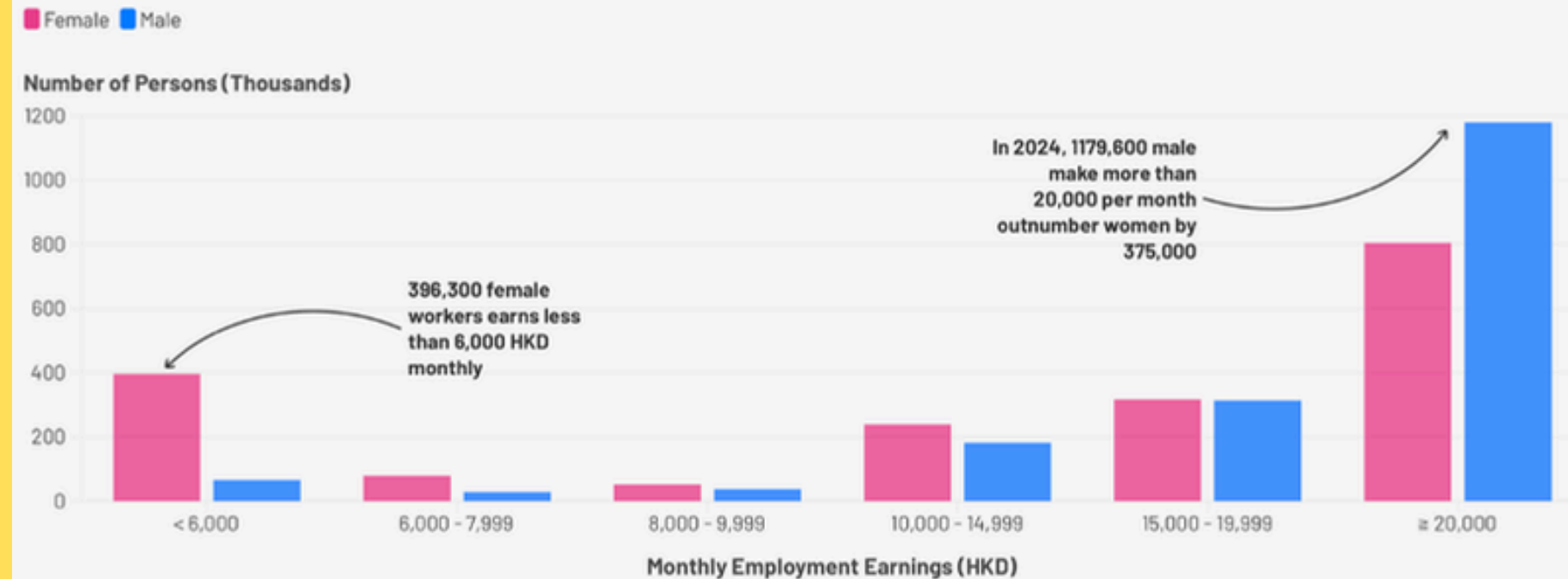


Our Data & Working Process



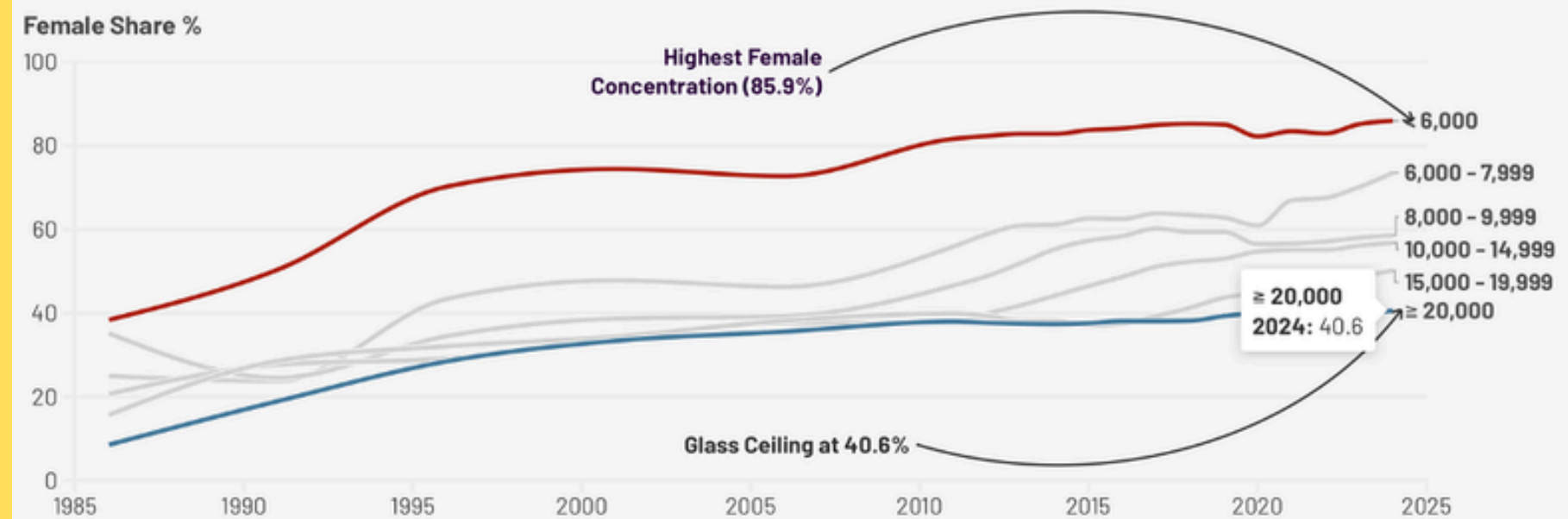
The Gender Pay Gap: Structural Inequality in Monthly Earnings (2024)

Comparative analysis of male and female employment distribution across different salary levels in Hong Kong.



Gender Gap in Earnings: 40 Years of Slow Progress

Despite growth in high-income earners, women remain concentrated in low-wage brackets and continue to lag behind men in higher-income tiers.



Finding 1: A Gap Built into the System

Celebrating the power and potential

- 2024: 396,300 women earn <HK\$6k/month — 85.9% of that bracket, 6× men
- 1986 context: only 51.2% of women were employed vs 80.9% men
- High-earners (≥HK\$20k): female workers grew 320× since 1986
- Yet men still outnumber women in high-income bracket by 375,000+





Finding 2: More Women Are in Charge

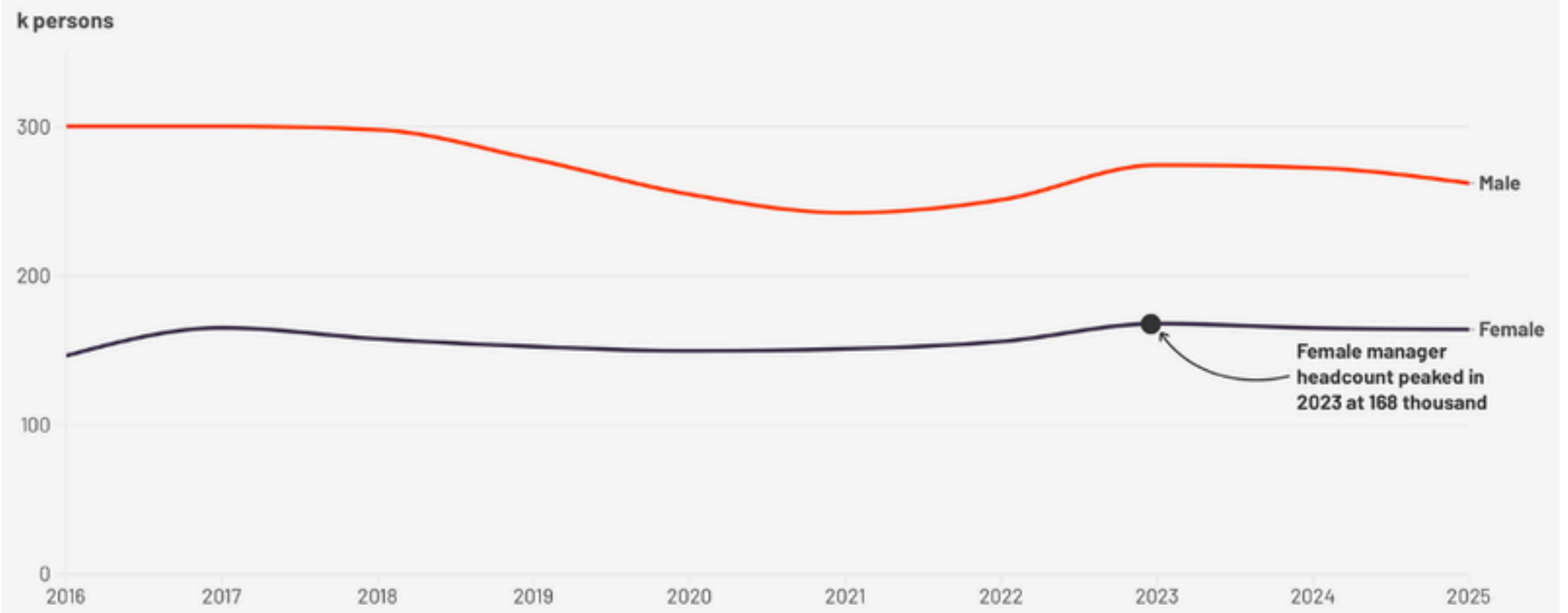


Female manager share: 32.8% (2016) → 38.5% (2025)
Finance sector even higher: 45% (KPMG 2025)

Real progress — but is it enough?

Female and male managers in Hong Kong (2016–2025)

Source: Hong Kong C&SD | number of managers, in thousands



Finding 3: Promotion $\neq$ Equal Pay

2024 median salary: Female manager HK\$45,900 vs Male HK\$49,600 (-7.5%)

Clerical level gap: only 4.7%

Sometimes Higher the rank $\rightarrow$ bigger the gap

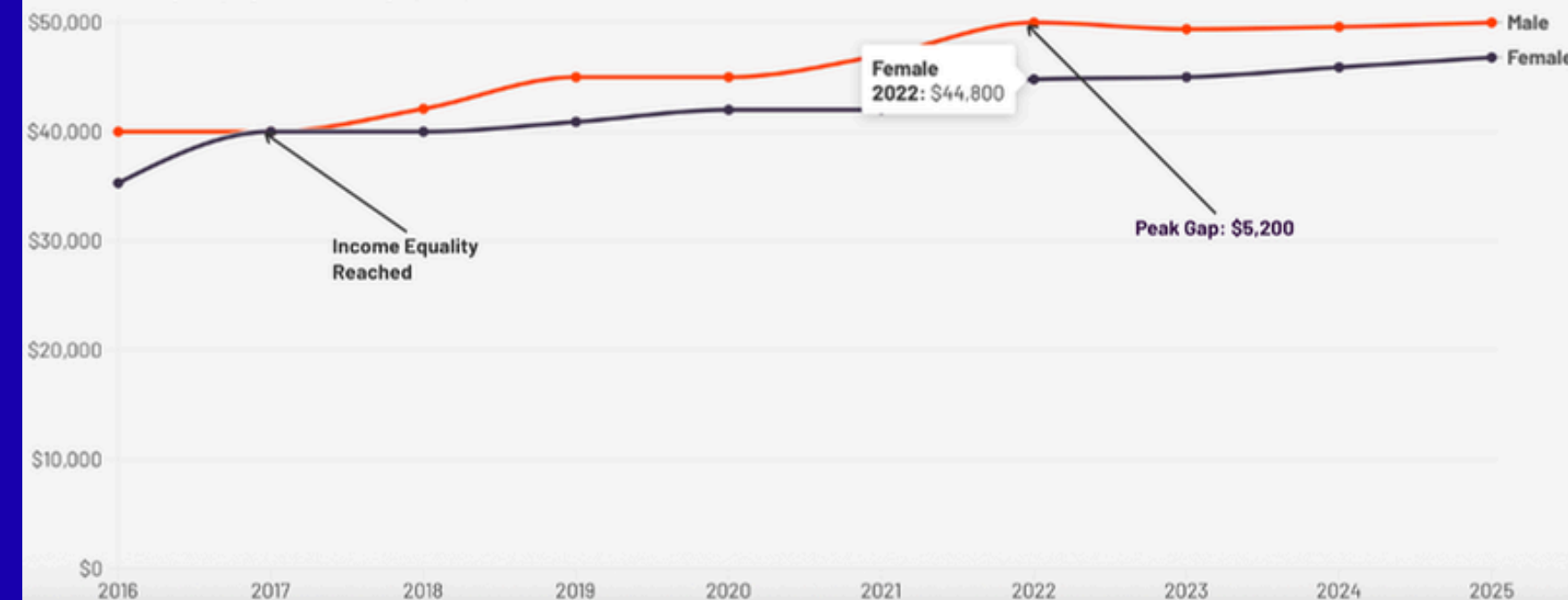
2022: widest gap ever at manager level — HK\$5,200/month difference

Promotion is real, but it doesn't buy equal pay

Gender Pay Gap Trends Among Managers in Hong Kong (2016–2025)

Median monthly employment earnings of managers. While parity was reached in 2017, a gap emerged thereafter, showing signs of narrowing in recent years.

Median Monthly Employment Earnings (HKD)



The Final Story



✓ 3-layer data argument

structural gap (DS1) → rising
representation (DS3) → persistent
pay gap (DS2)

✓ Interactive element

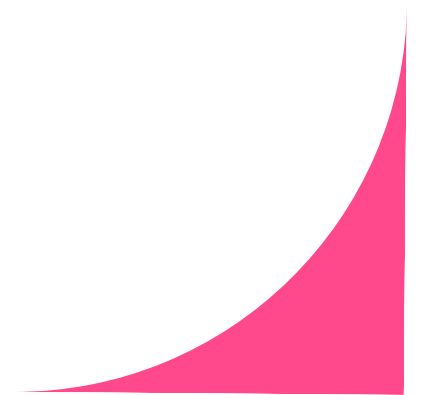
readers can explore salary data
directly

✓ Data visualizations

column charts, line chart, grouped
comparison

✓ Story angle

Glass ceiling hasn't been broken —
it's just harder to see





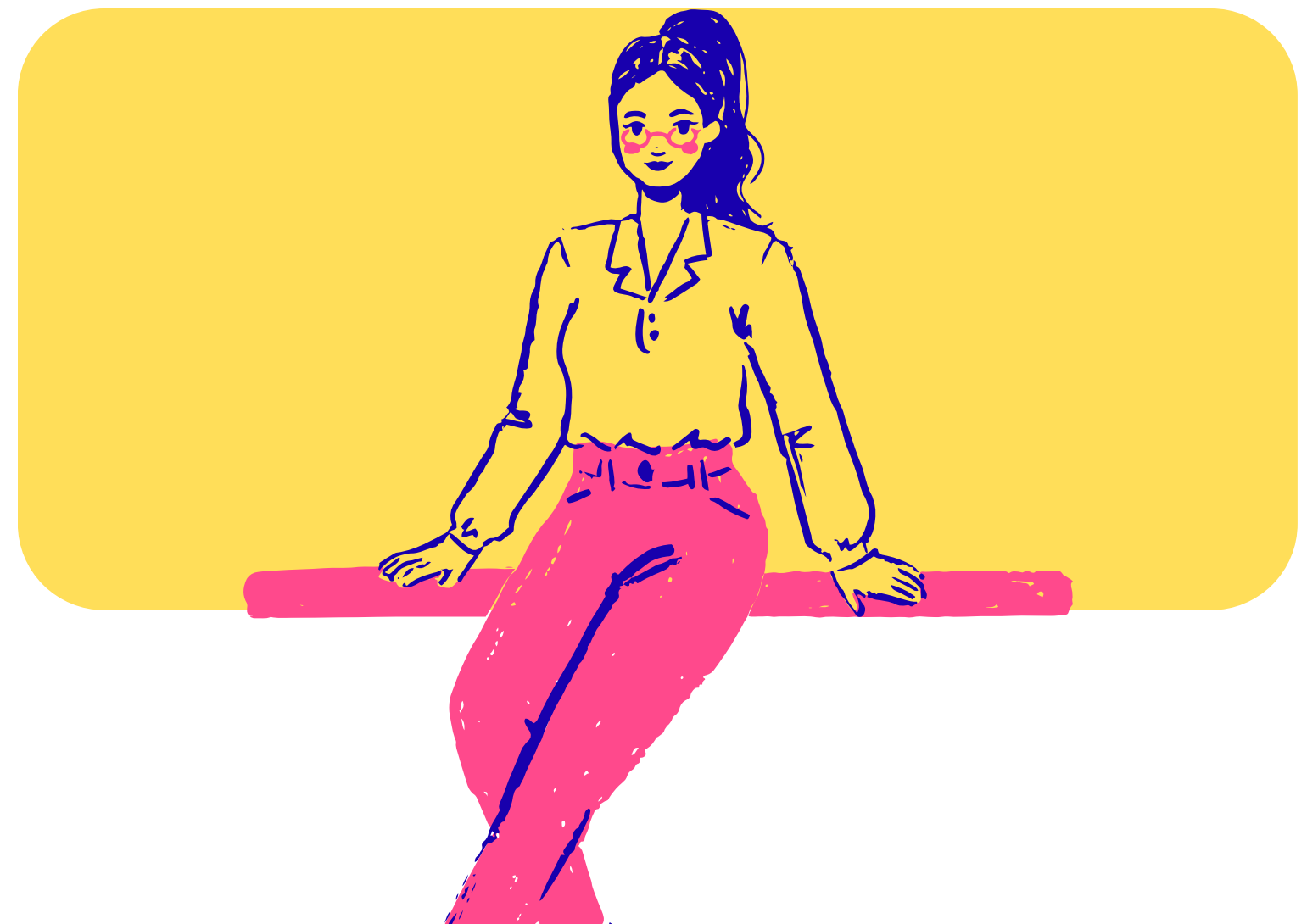
Women in HK have made measurable progress over 40 years

But structural wage inequality persists at the bottom

And at the top, promotion doesn't guarantee equal pay

The glass ceiling is still there — just more subtle

**"Progress is real —
but it is not enough."**





**Thank You
Very Much**